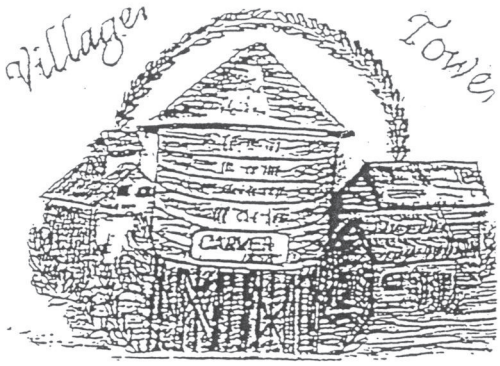
Volume XIX
Number # One Hundred Seventy Eight
March/April 2001



Public Safety

Two deputies from the Carver County Sheriff's office were present at the council meeting to discuss items with them. One issue discussed was that the department and the county are aware of traffic/stop sign issues on County Road #40. This corridor is being monitored and assessed for future needs. There are not any immediate plans for this issue. Council expressed concerns regarding excess speeding at this intersection considered dangerous. Speed was also discussed on Sixth Street.

Further discussion ensued regarding a study to be conducted to determine whether sign placement is warranted. A number of issues are used to determine this. An invitation should be extended to Mr. Roger Gustafson to discuss this issue.

Question was asked if it were possible to get a report that would include the activities in Carver during contracted hours. Concern was voiced regarding cost for additional patrol time. The council would like to see the times the squad car is in Carver and the activities taking place. A report could be generated; but it would take time to read log sheets to create an information sheet. It was decided that a quarterly report would be sufficient.

Abandoned Vehicles

The council discussed abandoned vehicles within the city. Enforcing the city ordinance was talked about. The attorney's opinion was asked for. His input was that the ordinance may need to be a little clearer and an action plan was necessary.

Miscellaneous

The mayor requested information and updates on potential flood assessments.



Municipal Utilities

The city engineer updated the council on the progress of drilling the test well. The initial drill showed that the aquifier was good, being porous. The next step is to drill the test well.

General Obligation Sewer And Water Revenue Bonds was discussed at the meeting. Two bids were received for the bonds. The purpose of the bonds is to refinance sewer debt and add Well #2/Pumphouse. Motion was made and carried by roll call vote adopting resolution accepting proposal on sale of General Obligation Sewer and Water Revenue bonds.

Public Hearing was held explaining necessity to increase municipal utilities fees. Connection fees had previously been increased. Increases are based on cost projections for maintenance and future projects. One resident commented that the cost of Carver's utilities was much higher than those city where he had resided. The city attorney suggested surcharges for a water treatment plant be paid soon. Motion was made and carried increasing municipal utilities rates and attaching a surcharge on the utility bills.

Church By The River Proposed Renovation

The council discussed the matter of the renovation of the Church-By-The-River. Bob Williams is the Project Foreman for the renovation of the structure. Mr Williams is a member of the Heritage Preservation Commission. A tentative timetable was discussed. Three major mechanical projects are to be done by June 1st. These would include heating, ventilation and air conditioning, plumbing and electrical. This project needs to done by bids.



Sunday Liquor Sales

The council discussed requests for amendment to the city code regarding times for liquor sales A Public Hearing would be required to make this change. Business owner requests allowing opening time at 10AM on Sundays instead of noon. The reason for the time change request is because people like to be able to watch sports games which begin at 11 AM usually. There is also the proposed idea of serving breakfast on Sunday mornings. Opening and closing times was debated. Motion was made and carried to change Sunday Bar Hours to 10 AM to 10PM; city staff and attorney to draft an amendment to the city ordinance scheduling a Public Hearing on the issue.

Fun Run

The Dog House Bar has sponsored a fundraiser in the past years entitled "Fun Run". The event has grown. All three bars in Carver are planning participation in the event. Council was asked to allow the closing of portions of Third Street so a band can be scheduled for the festivities. Motion was made and carried to allow Third Street East closure and the sale of liquor on public property by resolution.

Another request was submitted that in the case of rain the band be allowed the use of the Village Hall upstairs. Concerns were voiced regarding possible damage to the floor. Suggestion was then submitted that cancellation be the option in the event of rain.

Carver Lions

The Pancake Breakfast and the BullHead Feed were each very successful events. They would like to thank everyone for all their hard work and everyone who came to eat.

The Lions are presently in the planning stages for SteamBoat Days. Before you know it, September will be here.

REMINDER: New members are always welcome. The Lions meet the first and third Wednesday of each month at the Village Hall. Come and join them. Or just come and see what they are all about.

SteamBoat Days

By: Kathy Guenther

The SteamBoat Steering Committee met on March 28th. Some of the new events that are being planned for our 2001 celebration include:

Antique Car Show
City-Wide Garage Sale
Kiddie Karaoke
Historical Society Display
Walking Tour/Historical Homes
Expanded Craft Show
Line Dancing
Kiddie Parade

We are also coordinating more family orientated games and events on our Main Street throughout the weekend. We're looking for community volunteers to sign up for two hour time slots to run the games. What a great way to meet your neighbors!! Anyone high school age or older can sign up! Call Mary at 952) 361-6233 to schedule a slot. Further details and sign-up sheets for other events will be available at a later date. Our planning meetings are open to everyone. The next meeting is Wednesday, April 25th at 6:30 PM in the Village Hall Basement. Come and join us...The More the Merrier!!!

Fourth Street Improvements

Public Hearing was opened for the Fourth Street Improvements. An introduction was given. Orrin Thompson will be constructing a portion of the sidewalk in conjunction with the subdivision. Residents present at the meeting explained the need for a sidewalk in the area because presently one has to walk on the narrow street and they have concerns about safety. A cost summary had been completed. The cost of this project is not budgeted to be done; therefore, grant funds would be necessary. Administrator would apply for this grant. It does not seem feasible to expect the developer to be solely responsible for the cost. A possible contribution from the St Nicholas church was discussed.

Resident inquired about options if a grant were is available. The administrator explained that Tax Increment Funds may be used, or budget the cost into next year's budget or reapply for grant funds. Assessment process would probably be expensive. Administrator will continue working on revenue options.

Plans and specifications for the Fourth Street Improvement Project are almost complete. Proposed time table for the project include publishing advertisements for bids on March 15th, opening bids on April 5th and bid consideration on April 16th. Motion was made and carried by roll call vote adopting resolution approving the plans and specifications and ordering advertisement of bids.

Carver Bluffs Parkway

Public Hearing was opened for the Carver Bluffs Parkway Trail. Administrator gave a brief introduction concerning the trail. Currently there is not a specific method for funding this trail. However, a plan has been proposed for the development of the trail. Many residents voiced an opinion specifically for safety purposes.

Several options have been prepared by the city engineer pertaining to the trail. One option involved removing and replanting trees, another option involved construction of retaining walls or possibly moving the trail further from the road. Presently, there is no money budgeted for this project. DNR grant funds could be sought. However, there would still be a 50% requirement that the city match the amount. Administrator would like to receive public input on whether or not the trail is necessary and what option was preferred.

Citizens present at the Public Hearing stated that there were concerns about privacy, safety and maintaining the trail. There are certain standards required if a DNR grant is received. The width of the path was discussed.

Further discussion was pursued regarding maintenance of the trail. Comment was made that the city would maintain the path in spring, fall and summer, but winter would be challenging. This would have to be discussed with the Homeowner's Association of Carver Bluffs. One concern of the length of the path from Ramsey Avenue to Carver Bluffs Park.

Administrator stated that the US Fish and Wildlife recently purchased a large wetland near Highway #212 and County Road #40 and they may be interested in joining their Rapid Lakes Corridor.

The Public Hearing was closed and the Administrator reported that he will continue preparing the DNR grant.

Administrator discussed the DNR Outdoor Recreation Grant Program applications. Public Hearings were held regarding proposed sidewalk/trail along Fourth Street between Ash and Elm Streets and proposed trail along Carver Bluffs Parkway between Ramsey Avenue and Carver Bluffs Park. This grant could possibly provide some financial assistance for one or both projects. Motion was made and carried by roll call vote adopting resolution authorizing submission of grant applications to the DNR.

YellowStone Raccoons

No report this month



Carver Youth Softball Baseball Association

Registrations are completed for the Carver Youth Softball/Baseball Association. Coaches will be calling respective players in the near future. The season is expected to start the second week in May.

Junior Diabetes Fun Run

Carver will again be hosting the Junior Diabetes Fun Run on May 5th, Saturday. The Doghouse, Harvey's and Lisa's Place are all coordinating the event this year. You must sign up by noon. To participate, you must have almost anything motorized on wheels. The group is planning on making the trip to St Peter. Tickets are $10./each. This includes grand prize, food and a street dance. Be sure to come and join in on the fun.

Carver Department and Community Highlights

April 2001

April 1st - April Fools
Daylight Savings Begins
April 2nd - Council Meeting 6:30 PM
Happy Birthday Kelly!
April 4th - Happy Birthday Wayne!
April 5th - Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting Fire Drill Night
April 6th - Black Sox Turkey/Ham Bingo
April 8th - Palm Sunday
Passover
April 9th - Park and Recreation Board Meeting
April 13th - Good Friday
Orthodox Holy Friday
April 14th - Happy Birthday Barb!
April 15th - EASTER
Orthodox EASTER
April 16th - Council Meeting 6:30 PM
Fire Drill Night
April 17th - Happy Birthday Cheryl!
April 18th - Happy Birthday John!
April 22nd - Earth Day
April 25th - Secretaries Day
April 26th - Meeting Night

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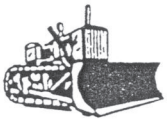




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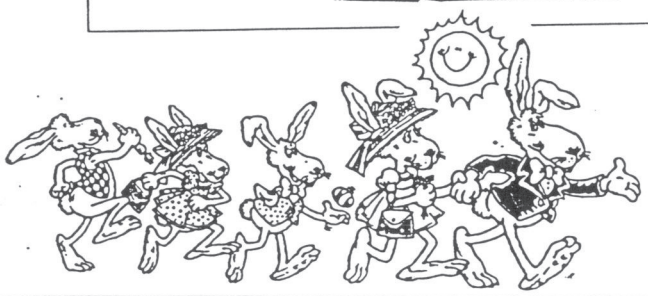
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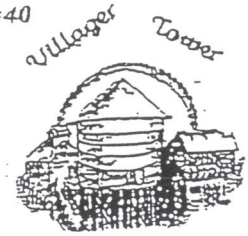


"Villager Tower"

If you want to submit an article, news, ad, editorial, then contact the "Villager Tower" at:

Villager Tower
14210 County Road #40
Carver MN 55315

Or Call:
(952) 448-5126



Spring Festival
Swap Meet
Antiques &
Craft Sale

May 5th & 6th 2001

Buy-Sell-Swap -Something for everyone -
Breakfast & Lunch –Demonstrations- Unique items
Gates open at 8:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m.
FREE admission
Location is
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19375 Fairview Lane
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Directly East of theScott-County Fairgrounds
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